

Sponge

At the bottom of the sea, growing on rocks and shipwrecks, you might catch sight of what at first look like very odd plants. Some of them are tube-shaped, and others look like bubble wrap, fingers, or jelly. These are actually simple animals, called sponges. They filter plankton to eat from the ocean around them by drawing water into their body through lots and lots of holes. These holes make sponges ideal for soaking up liquid, and some sponges are dried and used for washing-up or in the bath!

Some types, called glass sponges, may live for 10,000 years in the cold sea under the ice of the Antarctic. That makes them some of the oldest living things on Earth.

*Sponges come in all the colours of the rainbow,
and some even glow like neon signs!*

